



BEFORE

The Eastern Theater had seen a series of bloody battles in 1862 in which, largely through poor generalship, the increasing Union strength had gained little advantage.

HOOKER REFORMS THE FEDERAL ARMY



MAJOR GENERAL JOSEPH HOOKER

Replacing the inept Burnside as commander of the Army of the Potomac after the **defeat at Fredericksburg** (see [Burnside Takes the Offensive](#)), Major General Joseph Hooker restored morale by revising uniforms and ensuring rations and pay were distributed on time. He also improved the army's organization, **creating a military intelligence service**, consolidating the cavalry under one command, and **decentralizing the artillery**.

Major General Joseph Hooker drew up a grand operational plan for the Army of the Potomac in the spring of 1863. He would divide his 134,000-man force and lead three corps around General Lee's western flank, marching through the dense woods of the Virginia wilderness. At the same time, Major General John Sedgwick and the remaining three corps held Lee's attention at Fredericksburg.

Hooker's flanking force began its trek without incident in late April 1863 and succeeded in crossing both the Rappahannock and